



February 5, 2026

The Honorable Luke E. Torian
Chair, Virginia House Appropriations Committee
General Assembly Building
201 North 9th Street
Richmond, Virginia 23219

Dear Chairman Torian,

On behalf of the Loudoun Chamber of Commerce, I am writing to express our support for the proposed budget amendments to increase funding for Specially Adapted Resource Clubs (SPARC). We believe this funding increase warrants special attention, given its significant impact on individuals, families, and communities across Northern Virginia.

SPARC offers essential day programs for adults with multiple disabilities and complex medical needs at six locations, advancing the Commonwealth's ongoing efforts to comply with the ADA - efforts that remain under federal court oversight pursuant to a Permanent Injunction issued in *United States v. Virginia*. SPARC's programs provide a structured, supportive environment where participants develop life skills, access educational opportunities, participate fully in their communities, and build meaningful connections. By fostering independence and by offering meaningful choice, SPARC enables adults with developmental disabilities to live more expansive lives – lives shaped by full participation, deeper belonging, and genuine community integration.

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The budget amendments submitted by Delegate Reid and Senator Boysko (Items 300 #7h and 300 #8s) would fully fund SPARC's operations and allow the Department of Behavioral Health and Developmental Services to contract with SPARC at levels that reflect the true cost of service delivery. This funding is essential to sustaining SPARC's participant-directed, community-integrated model—one that has demonstrated effectiveness and fiscal responsibility.

From the perspective of the business community, inclusive workforce development and community-based services are not only moral imperatives but smart investments. SPARC's



model advances the Commonwealth's obligations cost-effectively, while strengthening families, reducing long-term public costs, and supporting a more inclusive regional economy.

Continued investment in SPARC represents a practical, compassionate, and economically sound approach to ensuring that adults with developmental disabilities have meaningful opportunities to learn, grow, and participate and be fully integrated in their communities.

The Loudoun Chamber of Commerce appreciates your leadership and consideration of this important matter. Please do not hesitate to contact me should you have any questions.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Anthony J. Howard". The signature is written in a cursive, flowing style.

Anthony J. Howard
President & CEO